

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Watch out for those electrical wires!



Learning Outcome

Describe ways of solving problems and getting things done at work and in social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- How dangerous is it to fix electrical problems by yourself?
- What type of accidents can someone suffer from when fixing household problems?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about household problems.
- I can react to things going wrong and how to solve problems.
- I can talk about things that need to be done.





Let's Explore!

Peter electrocutes himself! Ouch!



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Peter: Whoops! Ow! Ow! Ouch that hurt.

Vanessa: What now?

Peter: Well since you and Sal have pointed out some the issues with this place, I have realized that a couple of lamps need repairing.

Sally: Well, don't electrocute yourself! Did you unplug it first?

Peter: Of course I unplugged it. Do you think I am total moron?

Sally: Don't take your anger out on me.

Vanessa: Shhhh! I am trying to watch this podcast. Stop bickering! You sound like an old married couple.

Peter: Well ... dammit! This is the most frustrating piece of workmanship I've ever seen. It needs to be repaired.

Vanessa: It's possible that it isn't the lamp that needs fixing.

Peter: I am not in the mood for another snarky remark from either of you.

Vanessa: I am suggesting that maybe it's the entire building that needs rewiring! Maybe you are wasting time. Besides didn't you buy those lamps when you moved in?

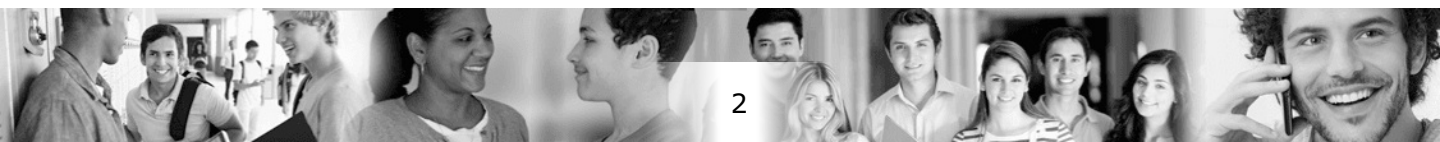
Peter: They are fairly new but I thought they might both be on the blink.

Sally: I guess one possible solution is to plug something else in. Then we'll see if it works.

Peter: Really? I swear, you must think I'm a total dud! I plugged in the toaster this morning to test out the sockets.

Vanessa: I think we need to take a break and have a little lunch. Peter, you might be getting testy because you're hungry.

Peter: It's not that. There is so much that needs to be fixed around here that I am overwhelmed!





Let's Practice!

Peter's lamps are on the blink!

Instructions: Make a line to match the words and their definitions.

COLUMN A

1. To be on the blink
2. To electrocute
3. To unplug
4. Snarky
5. To take something out on somebody

COLUMN B

- a. to blame someone
- b. irritable
- c. to not work well
- d. to remove from a socket
- e. to get an electric shock



Let's Practice!

I wonder if something else needs fixing!

Instructions: Proofread the sentences. Select the mistake. Write the correct words.

1. I have realized that a cuple off lamps need repairing.
2. It's possible that it isn't the lamp that needs fix.
3. I am suggest dat maybe it's the entire building that needs rewiring!
4. There is so much that needs to bee fixxed around here that I am overwhelmed!
5. This lamp needz two be repaired.





Extension Activity

Explain how to fix something in your house.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Find a problem in your house that needs to be fixed.
- Describe the steps to fix it.
- Write the steps to fixing the problem (use simple present).
- Read your description to a friend.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I talk about a household problem.

☐ ☐

I describe the steps to fix the problem.

☐ ☐

I write about fixing the problem.

☐ ☐

I read the description about a household problem.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **to electrocute** (verb): to get injured by an electric shock
e.g. Well, don't electrocute yourself!
- **to unplug** (verb): to disconnect by removing a plug from an electrical connection
e.g. Did you unplug it first?
- **moron** (noun): a person who is stupid or lacking in good judgment
e.g. Do you think I am total moron?
- **to take out on** (expression): to make someone else suffer or be responsible for your own mistakes
e.g. Don't take your anger out on me.
- **snarky** (adjective): testy or irritable
e.g. I am not in the mood for another snarky remark from either of you.
- **to be on the blink** (verb): to be out of order
e.g. I thought they might both be on the blink.
- **dud** (noun): a person that proves to be a failure
e.g. You must think I'm a total dud!
- **testy** (adjective): irritable, impatient
e.g. You might be getting testy because you're hungry.





Learning Points

Need to be Fixed or Needs Fixing

Need + passive infinitive and **need + verb + ing** are two structures you use to talk about fixing problems. You use these structures to imply that we don't know who will fix the problem, or that the person fixing the problem is not the focus of the sentence.

Subject + *Need* + Passive Infinitive

There is so much that needs to be fixed around here!

The subject of the sentence is the thing that needs fixing/to be fixed.

Subject + *Need* + Verb + *ing*

I have realized that a couple of lamps need repairing.

Need + Verb + ing

Subject	Form of need	Main Verb + <i>ing</i>
A couple of lamps	need	repairing.
... that	needs	fixing.
The entire building that	needs	rewiring.

Examples:

- *I have realized that a couple of lamps **need repairing**.*
- *It **needs to be repaired**.*
- *It's possible that it isn't the lamp that **needs fixing**.*
- *Maybe it's the entire building that **needs rewiring**!*
- *There is so much that **needs to be fixed** around here!*





Learning Points

Language of Reaction

We use paralanguage to react to a situation. These are sounds you use to show an emotional reaction.

Here are some examples:

Whoops! - shows a mistake or error has been made.

Ow! - shows pain.

Shhh! - shows you want people to be quiet.

Dammit! - shows anger or frustration.

Examples:

- *Whoops!*
- *Ow! Ow! Ouch that hurt.*
- *Shhhh! I am trying to watch this podcast.*
- *Well ... dammit!*

